

Racket sports

There are many different racket sports, but they all need similar skills: good hand-eye coordination, quick reactions, speed, fitness, and agility. Most racket sports can be played by two people (1 vs 1, known as singles) or four people (2 vs 2, known as doubles).

TENNIS

Players take it in turns to serve and can score points whenever their opponent fails to return a ball over the net or hits the ball out of play. Tennis (also known as lawn tennis) matches are made up of games and sets, with players needing to win six games to win a set. Matches can last for hours as a player must always win the final set by two games.



BEST OF THREE OR FIVE SETS



SINGLES OR DOUBLES

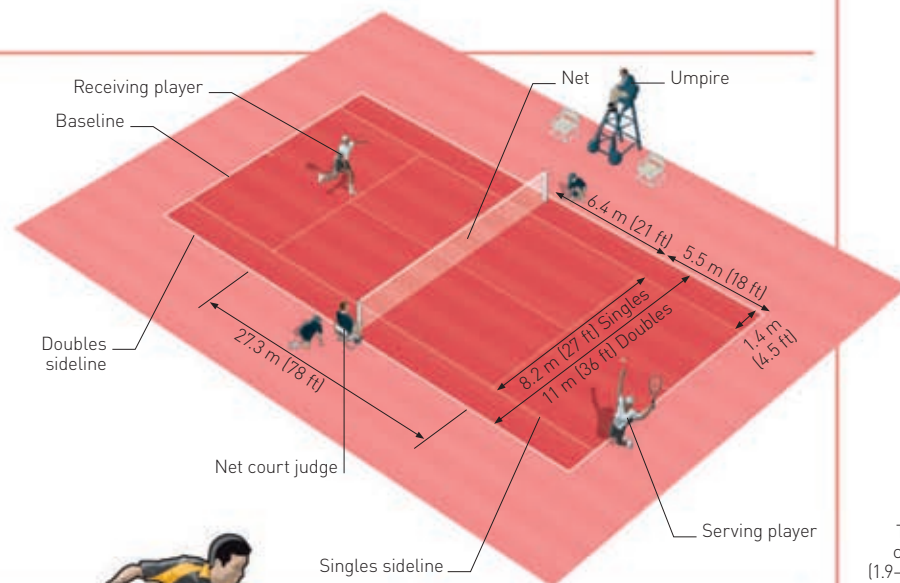


TABLE TENNIS

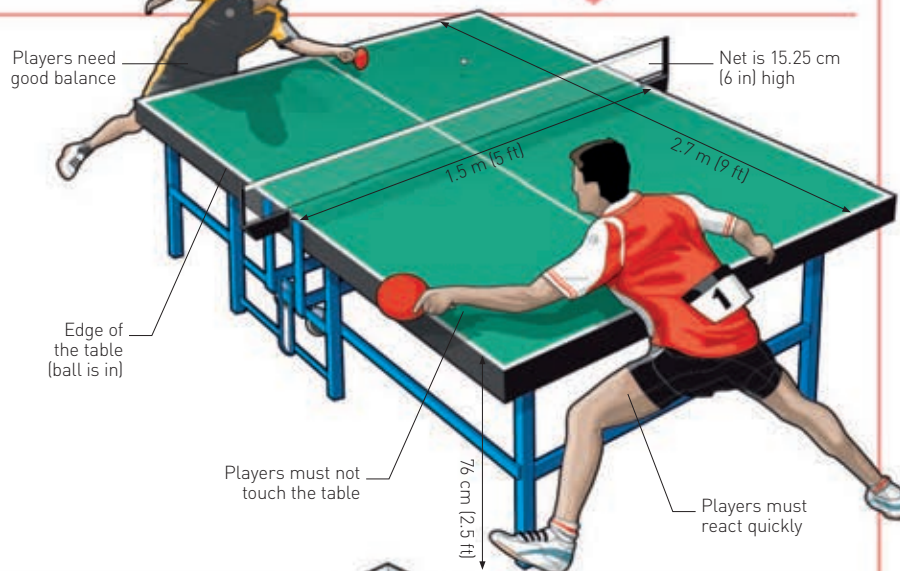
A player wins a point if his or her opponent cannot return the ball or if the return does not land on the table. The first player to score 11 points wins the game. However, if both players score 10 points, the first player to gain a two-point advantage wins the game. Table tennis is also known as ping pong.



BEST OF FIVE OR SEVEN GAMES



SINGLES OR DOUBLES



SQUASH

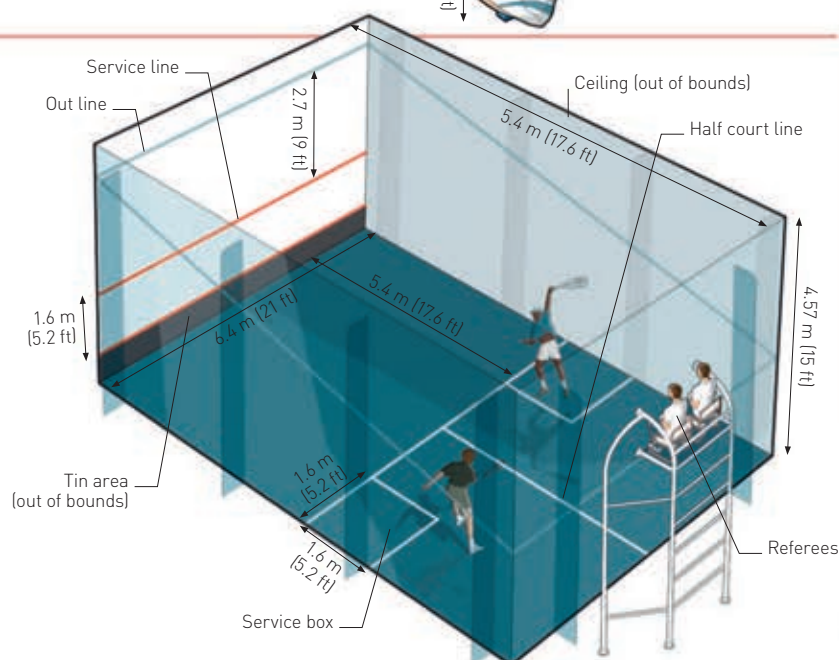
Squash is played on a four-walled court and players take it in turns to serve. They can win points if their opponent fails to hit the ball after it has bounced once, or if they hit the ball out of bounds. A player needs 11 points to win the game, but if the score is tied at 10-10, a player needs to win by two points.



THE BEST OF 3 OR 5 GAMES



SINGLES (DOUBLES CAN BE PLAYED ON A BIGGER COURT)



EQUIPMENT

Most rackets have a metal or wooden frame containing a network of strings. The tightness and density of the strings affects the way in which the racket controls the ball. What a ball is made of, its size, and weight can also affect the speed and style of the game.



TENNIS RACKET

TENNIS BALL

Tennis balls are made of rubber, covered in felt and weigh 56–59 g (1.9–2 oz). During a match, balls may be hit so hard that they lose their bounce and need to be replaced.

TABLE TENNIS BAT



TABLE TENNIS BALL
Made of celluloid and filled with gas, a table tennis ball weighs a mere 2.7 g (0.1 oz).



SQUASH RACKET

SQUASH BALL

Squash balls are made of hollow rubber. A coloured dot shows how fast or bouncy the ball is – orange is the slowest and blue the fastest.